

RAMCO VIDYA MANDIR SR. SEC. SCHOOL, THAMARAikulAM
CLASS 12 ENGLISH REVISION – PR 1 THE LAST LESSON

Marks : 15
Duration : 30 Minutes

Name :
Exam No. :

1. Extract-Based Comprehensions with Answers (5)

Extract 1: *"The corridor I was in began angling left and slanting downward and I thought that was wrong, but I kept on walking. All I could hear was the empty sound of my own footsteps and I didn't pass a soul."*

Question 1: What does Charley describe about the corridor? *Answer:* Charley mentions that the corridor angled left and slanted downward, giving a mysterious feeling that it was out of place.

Question 2: Why does Charley not stop walking despite his doubts? *Answer:* Charley is curious and hopeful to discover the third level, so he continues walking despite the oddity of the corridor.

Extract 2: *"I turned toward the ticket windows knowing that here—on the third level at Grand Central—I could buy tickets that would take Louisa and me anywhere in the United States we wanted to go. In the year 1894."*

Question 1: Why does Charley want tickets to Galesburg? *Answer:* Galesburg represents a peaceful and idyllic life free from the pressures of the modern world.

Question 2: What is the significance of 1894 in this extract? *Answer:* It symbolizes nostalgia and escapism, a simpler time Charley desires to visit.

Extract 3: *"My stamp collecting, for example; that's a 'temporary refuge from reality.' Well, maybe, but my grandfather didn't need any refuge from reality; things were pretty nice and peaceful in his day."*

Question 1: How does Charley defend his stamp collecting? *Answer:* Charley explains that his grandfather started the stamp collection when life was peaceful and stress-free.

Question 2: What does the psychiatrist mean by "temporary refuge from reality"? *Answer:* He implies that Charley uses stamp collecting as a way to escape the stress of his current life.

Extract 4: *"The lights were dim and sort of flickering. Then I saw why; they were open-flame gaslights. There were brass spittoons on the floor."*

Question 1: What do open-flame gaslights and brass spittoons represent? *Answer:* They reflect the historical setting of the 1890s, reinforcing the atmosphere of the third level.

Question 2: How does Charley react to this setting? *Answer:* Charley feels fascinated and believes he has truly stepped into the past.

Extract 5: *"The note is signed Sam. At the stamp and coin store I go to, I found out that Sam bought eight hundred dollars' worth of old-style currency."*

Question 1: What does Sam's note reveal? *Answer:* It shows that Sam found the third level and is living in 1894.

Question 2: What is Charley's reaction to Sam's actions? *Answer:* Charley feels a mix of surprise and hope, believing the third level truly exists.

2. Assertion-Reasoning Questions with Answers.

- Assertion (A):** Charley believed he could travel to 1894 through the third level. **Reason (R):** He wanted to escape the stress of modern life. **Answer:** a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
- Assertion (A):** Charley's stamp collection is a refuge from reality. **Reason (R):** His grandfather started the collection in peaceful times. **Answer:** b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
- Assertion (A):** Charley finds fewer ticket windows on the third level. **Reason (R):** The setting reflects 1890s architecture. **Answer:** a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
- Assertion (A):** Sam purchased old-style currency. **Reason (R):** He wanted to escape to 1894. **Answer:** a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
- Assertion (A):** The psychiatrist dismissed Charley's belief in the third level. **Reason (R):** He considered it a symptom of anxiety. **Answer:** a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
- Assertion (A):** Sam's letter confirms the existence of the third level. **Reason (R):** It is postmarked 1894. **Answer:** a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
- Assertion (A):** Charley wanted tickets to Galesburg. **Reason (R):** Galesburg was an ideal representation of peace for him. **Answer:** a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
- Assertion (A):** The third level symbolizes escapism. **Reason (R):** It represents a departure from modern-day challenges. **Answer:** a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.
- Assertion (A):** Louisa was initially skeptical about Charley's experiences. **Reason (R):** She believed Charley was overly imaginative. **Answer:** b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.
- Assertion (A):** Charley searched the public library for evidence of the third level. **Reason (R):** He wanted to find proof of its historical existence. **Answer:** a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A.

3. Competency-Based Short Questions.

- What is the setting of the third level?** *Answer:* It is a dimly lit area with open-flame gaslights, brass spittoons, and fewer ticket windows, reflecting the 1890s.
- Why does Charley buy old-style currency?** *Answer:* He believes it will help him travel back to 1894 seamlessly.
- What does Sam's letter signify?** *Answer:* It proves that the third level exists and that Sam successfully reached 1894.

4. **What role does nostalgia play in Charley's life?** *Answer:* Nostalgia provides Charley a temporary escape from the stress of modern life.
5. **How does the author blend fantasy and reality?** *Answer:* By merging realistic details of Grand Central Station with the imaginative third level.
6. **What emotions does Galesburg represent for Charley?** *Answer:* Peace, simplicity, and a life free of modern anxieties.
7. **What does Charley's stamp collection symbolize?** *Answer:* It represents his connection to the past and his refuge from reality.
8. **What evidence supports Charley's belief in the third level?** *Answer:* Sam's letter postmarked 1894 and his detailed experience support his belief.
9. **What is the significance of Louisa joining Charley's search?** *Answer:* It symbolizes emotional support and trust in their relationship.
10. **Why does the story leave the third level's existence ambiguous?** *Answer:* To engage readers in interpreting it as either a psychological escape or a mystical phenomenon.

Value-Based Short Questions (2 Marks Each)

1. **What value does the story convey about the importance of one's language?**
Answer: The story emphasizes the significance of cherishing and preserving one's native language as a symbol of identity and heritage.
2. **How does M. Hamel inspire respect for the French language?**
Answer: M. Hamel passionately explains that one's language is the key to freedom and culture, inspiring love and respect for French among his students.
3. **What does Franz's regret teach us about education?**
Answer: Franz's regret highlights the value of consistent learning and the importance of appreciating education before it's too late.
4. **Why is the story relevant to cultural preservation?**
Answer: It reflects the importance of safeguarding one's language and culture in the face of oppression and external control.
5. **What lesson can we draw about taking things for granted?**
Answer: The story teaches us to value opportunities, like education, before they are taken away.
6. **How does M. Hamel's behavior reflect patriotism?**
Answer: His emotional delivery of the last lesson shows his deep pride in the French language and culture.
7. **How is the villagers' presence in the classroom symbolic?**
Answer: It signifies unity, the regret of lost opportunities, and the collective pride in their language.
8. **What message does the story give about loss and regret?**
Answer: It portrays how people often realize the importance of something only after it's gone.
9. **How does Franz's change of heart reflect personal growth?**

Answer: His newfound respect for M. Hamel and French highlights his maturity and awareness of what truly matters.

10. What is the significance of the phrase “Vive La France” at the end?

Answer: It reflects the undying spirit of nationalism and pride in one’s heritage despite external suppression.

Long Answers (200-250 Words) (Answers are given with sub headings for your best understanding. You need not use them in your answers)

1. Value-Based Question

Question: What values does *The Last Lesson* teach us about language and identity?

Answer: Introduction: Alphonse Daudet’s *The Last Lesson* highlights the powerful connection between language, identity, and patriotism. The story’s poignant narrative emphasizes the enduring value of one’s native tongue.

Content: The imposition of German as the official language in Alsace and Lorraine underscores the loss of cultural freedom. Through the character of M. Hamel, the story teaches us to cherish our language, as it represents our identity and a tool for preserving our heritage. M. Hamel’s emotional delivery of the last French lesson inspires a sense of responsibility among the villagers and students to honor their language. The regret experienced by Franz and the collective sorrow of the villagers illustrate the consequences of neglecting one’s language and education. The phrase "Vive La France," written on the board, symbolizes the resilience of the human spirit and the hope to reclaim their cultural identity.

Conclusion: The story conveys a timeless message: language is more than a medium of communication—it is the heart of one’s cultural and national identity. Preserving it is essential to safeguarding our freedom and heritage.

2. Story-Based Question

Question: How does *The Last Lesson* reflect the impact of political changes on individuals?

Answer: Introduction: Daudet’s story sheds light on the consequences of political decisions on ordinary lives, particularly through the lens of language imposition.

Content: The Prussian decree that enforces German in schools disrupts the daily life of the villagers. It creates a sense of loss and helplessness among individuals, especially M. Hamel and Franz. M. Hamel’s sadness and anger reflect his deep love for the French language, while Franz’s regret highlights how political decisions can impact one’s education and opportunities. The presence of the villagers in the classroom demonstrates their collective grief over losing their cultural identity. Political changes, as shown in the story, not only affect governance but also influence the emotional and intellectual lives of individuals.

Conclusion: *The Last Lesson* serves as a powerful reminder of how political decisions can erode personal freedoms, emphasizing the importance of unity and resilience in preserving one’s cultural identity.

3. Theme-Based Question

Question: Discuss the theme of regret as depicted in *The Last Lesson*.

Answer: Introduction: Regret is a central theme in Daudet's *The Last Lesson*, portrayed through the reactions of Franz, M. Hamel, and the villagers.

Content: Franz regrets taking his lessons lightly and realizes the value of education only on the day he loses it. M. Hamel regrets the lack of collective efforts to teach and preserve the French language. His words convey sorrow about wasted opportunities, both by him as a teacher and by the villagers as parents who prioritized work over their children's education. The villagers' attendance in the classroom reflects their regret for neglecting their language and culture. This collective realization demonstrates how people often fail to appreciate what they have until it is too late.

Conclusion: The story beautifully encapsulates the theme of regret, teaching us the importance of valuing education and cultural identity before they are lost.

4. Character-Based Question

Question: Analyze the character of M. Hamel in *The Last Lesson*.

Answer: Introduction: M. Hamel, the French teacher, serves as a symbol of dedication, patriotism, and remorse in Alphonse Daudet's *The Last Lesson*.

Content: M. Hamel is initially strict but deeply passionate about his role as a teacher. His emotional attachment to the French language is evident in his sorrowful yet determined delivery of the last lesson. He openly acknowledges the collective negligence in preserving their language and encourages his students and the villagers to take pride in their heritage. His actions, such as dressing formally for the last lesson and writing "Vive La France," reflect his patriotism. Despite his regret, M. Hamel leaves an enduring impact on his students and community, inspiring them to value their identity.

Conclusion: M. Hamel represents resilience and dedication, leaving readers with a powerful lesson on the importance of language, culture, and unity.

5. Article-Based Question

Title: *The Power of Language in Shaping Identity*

by xyz

Language is the cornerstone of a person's identity. It is a bridge that connects individuals to their culture, history, and community. Alphonse Daudet's *The Last Lesson* beautifully portrays the significance of language in preserving national pride and unity.

The story revolves around the Prussian imposition of German in French schools, leading to a sense of loss among the villagers. It highlights how language suppression can erode cultural identity. M. Hamel's passionate efforts to teach French for the last time underline the power of language as a unifying force. The villagers' regret for neglecting their language reflects a profound realization of its value.

In conclusion, *The Last Lesson* reminds us that language is not just a tool for communication; it is a repository of our heritage and a testament to our identity. Preserving it is essential for safeguarding the soul of a community.

6. Speech-Based Question

Title: *Cherishing Our Language*

Good morning, everyone.

Today, I want to talk about the importance of preserving our language, inspired by Alphonse Daudet's *The Last Lesson*. Language is not merely a means of communication—it is the soul of our identity, heritage, and culture.

In the story, the imposition of German in French schools highlights the vulnerability of cultural identity under political pressures. M. Hamel's emotional last lesson reminds us to value our language, as it represents our freedom and pride. Franz's regret and the villagers' sorrow teach us that we often realize the importance of what we have only after it is taken away.

Let us cherish and preserve our language, for it is the heart of who we are. Thank you.

7. Conversation-Based Question

Question: Write a conversation between Franz and M. Hamel after the last lesson.

Answer:

Franz: Monsieur Hamel, I'm so sorry I didn't appreciate your lessons earlier.

M. Hamel: Franz, it's not just your fault. We all took our language for granted. But it's never too late to learn.

Franz: But what can I do now? We can't study French anymore.

M. Hamel: Even if you cannot study it formally, you can continue to use and honor it. Speak it, write it, and pass it on to others.

Franz: I promise to do that. Thank you for showing us how important our language is.

M. Hamel: Always remember, Franz, our language is part of who we are. Never let it fade away.